

◀ PEACE OF AUGSBURG

In Germany, Holy Roman Emperor Charles V, a devout Catholic, led the attacks against Luther. But many German princes became Protestants. In an attempt to end this religious conflict, the Peace of Augsburg (1555) agreed that each German prince was free to decide which religion his subjects should follow.

Seal of a German ruler



CALVINISM ▶

By the 1550s, Protestantism had split into two main branches—Lutheranism, which followed the ideas of Luther, and Calvinism, founded by Frenchman John Calvin (right), who fled from Catholic France to Switzerland. The Calvinists followed a simpler, and stricter, form of worship than Lutherans.



COUNCIL OF TRENT ▲

Alarmed by the spread of Protestantism, Pope Paul II gathered Catholic leaders to meet several times between 1545 and 1563. This "Council of Trent" launched the Counter Reformation to strengthen the loyalty of Church members. Churches were built in an ornate style and music was encouraged to make worship more attractive.

WARS OF RELIGION

Both Catholics and Protestants carried out violent acts during the religious wars that followed the Reformation. The wars were mainly fought in Germany, France, and the Netherlands and did not come to an end until 1648. Catholic Spanish soldiers can be seen here sacking the Protestant city of Antwerp in the Netherlands in 1576.

